

UNIT 1 / Your first conversations

Hear the difference

Your goal: Recognise common sound patterns and practise clear pronunciation.

01 Learn the idea

Learn sounds in words: ei in mein sounds roughly like English eye, while ie in sie is a long ee sound. Eu in neu is roughly oy. Read mein and sie slowly, then in a sentence. The order of the letters matters: changing ei to ie can create a different word.

Sch in Schule is like English sh. At the start of a stressed syllable, sp and st often begin with a sh-like sound, as in sprechen and Straße. German w sounds like English v in Wasser. Pronunciation varies by region, so aim for an understandable standard pattern and listen more than once.

Words and phrases

German	English
mein Name	my name
sie lernen	they learn
die Schule	the school
das Wasser	the water
Deutsch sprechen	to speak German

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Teacher

Sprechen Sie Deutsch?

Do you speak German?

Learner

Ein bisschen. Bitte langsam.

A little. Slowly, please.

Teacher

Sehr gut! Noch einmal: Schule.

Very good! Once again: school.

Your real-life mission

Make two columns headed ei and ie. Add mein, nein, sie and sieben. Read each column aloud, then practise Schule and Wasser three times.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “mein Name” mean?

- A. my name
- B. they learn
- C. the school

2. What does “sie lernen” mean?

- A. the school
- B. they learn
- C. the water

3. What does “die Schule” mean?

- A. the water
- B. to speak German
- C. the school

4. Which spelling commonly represents a long ee sound?

- A. ie
- B. ei
- C. eu

5. What does the learner ask the teacher to do?

- A. Write a letter
- B. Speak slowly
- C. Leave

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - my name

“mein Name” means “my name”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - they learn

“sie lernen” means “they learn”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - the school

“die Schule” means “the school”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. A - ie

Ie as in sie usually has a long ee sound. Ei as in mein is different.

5. B - Speak slowly

Bitte langsam asks for a slower pace.

One possible mission response

ei: mein, nein. ie: sie, sieben. Ich spreche ein bisschen Deutsch.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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